

Prebuilt

Every printer learns from every other. No data leaves.

Precision manufacturing for labs that can't share their data: each machine learns its own errors and gets better with every machine that joins. Patient scans, part geometry and measurements stay home.

ScienceClaw · Manufacturing & Materials · MIT Media Lab

THE PROBLEM

Labs that print can't share what they learn

Guides, crowns and implants from patient scans

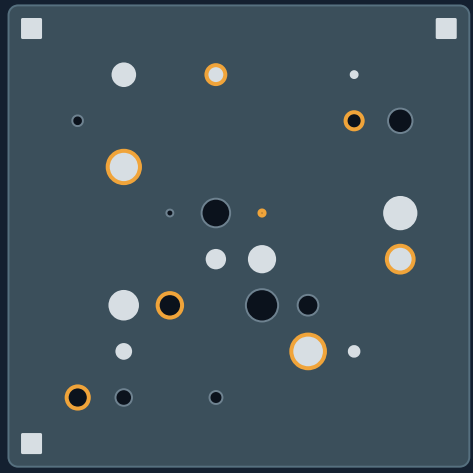
They must seat on the first print, and the scans are protected health data.

Microfluidic chips and bioprinted scaffolds

Sub-millimetre features, and every test print costs days and material.

Every printer is wrong in its own way

Holes print small and pins fat, by tens to hundreds of µm. Only printing reveals it.



The test plate: 24 pins and holes, 1–7 mm. Print it, measure it, know your printer.

Can printers learn from each other without sharing a single measurement?

BUILT ON PROVEN SCIENCE

Each piece is proven. Doing it privately is new

THE ERROR IS REAL

−250 µm

holes undersized and pins up to +195 µm on a desktop SLA printer, measured by CMM.

Tehnički vjesnik, 2026 (54 specimens, 5–20 mm)

CORRECTING IT WORKS

Model → fix

learn each printer's shape error, then print a compensated design.

Huang, Zhang, Sabbaghi, Dasgupta, IISE Transactions 47(5), 2015

SHARING HELPS

Data-poor

printers predict quality better by learning jointly with other printers.

Wei, Wang, Dickens, Chi, IISE Transactions 55(4), 2023; Sabbaghi & Huang, Ann. Appl. Stat. 12(4), 2018

The gap: cross-printer learning so far pools raw data or moves models centrally, and federated learning in printing covers defect images (Tang et al., RCIM 2024). Prebuilt shares three numbers, and nothing else leaves the lab.

HOW IT WORKS

Learn locally, share three numbers

1 Print a test plate

24 pins and holes. Measure them by micrometer or flatbed scanner.

2 Learn your printer

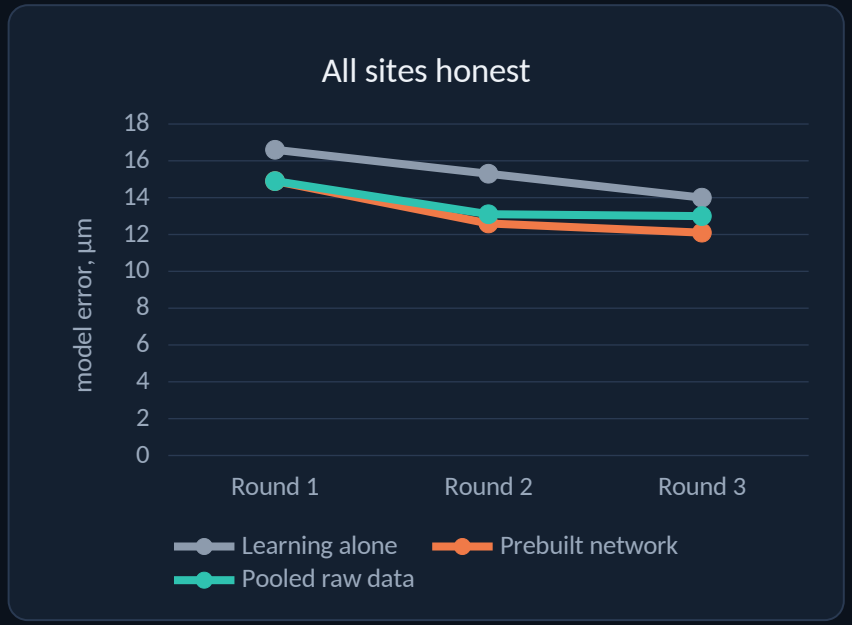
A physics model of your machine, fit locally on your own data.

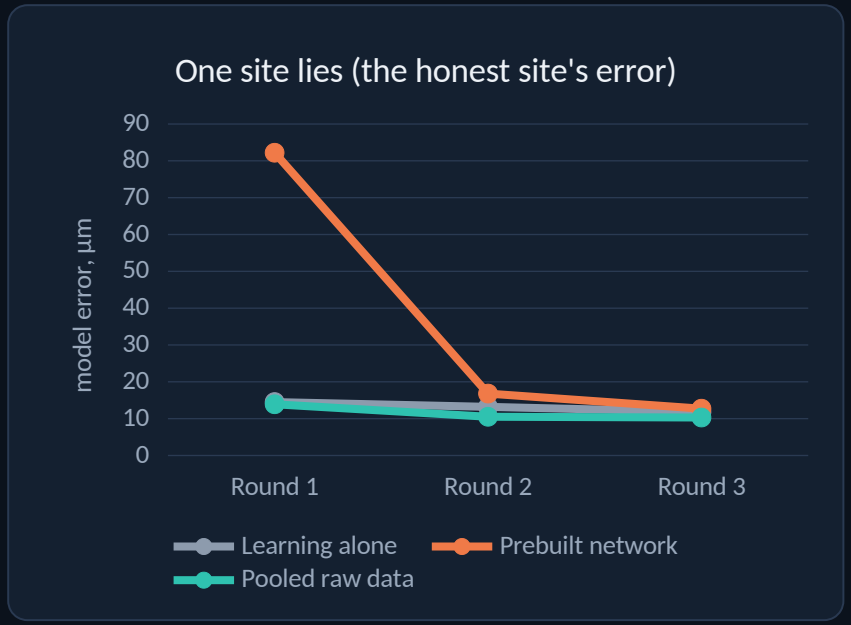
3 Share three numbers

Mean and spread of 3 parameters every printer shares. Schema-checked, logged on a receipt.

Never leaves the lab: patient scans, part geometry, measurements, machine settings. A replayable privacy audit checks every crossing: 0 measurements crossed.

The network learns faster, and shrugs off a liar





RESULTS · SIMULATION

Parts that fit, and new labs get there faster

9 µm

size error from a corrected design, against 132 µm drawn as-is. For scale: crown margins must be under ~120 µm.

35%

lower error for labs with little data when eight share. The network won 20 of 20 simulated fleets.

12%

lower error with just two labs, matching what pooling all raw data gives (won 75 of 100 fleets).

0 rounds

lost to a lying lab with the consistency check: 180 of 180 lies caught, 0 honest notes dropped.

A real printer for scale, simulation to score

Registered first

Every claim and prediction was committed, with its hash on record, before the first print.

Negative control

When printers share no physics, sharing gains nothing. The gain isn't built into the scoring.

Scored against known truth

Simulation checks every prediction against the true printed size, which a real measurement can't: two micrometer readings of one pin differ by 65 µm.

REAL PRINTER · FORM STUDIO 1

1.44 mm

a 1.50 mm pin, by micrometer (two readings: 1.41 and 1.48)

- Inside the vendor's ±0.08 mm spec
- Inside the simulator, at its small edge
- Next: calibrate on the full 24-piece plate

WHO IT'S FOR

For anyone whose precision is a trade secret

NOW · MEDICAL AND BIO

Hospital 3D-printing labs

Surgical guides from patient scans. Scans stay in-house.

Dental labs

Crowns and aligners must seat first time. Patient data can't pool.

Bio and microfluidics labs

Sub-mm lab-on-chip parts. Recipes are IP.

NEXT · HIGH-PRECISION INDUSTRY

Chip makers, GPU packaging

Every nanometre is yield, and process recipes are the company.

Defense and aerospace

Export-controlled technical data can't leave the site.

MEMS and nanotech

Sub-micron parts, closely held processes, scarce test data.

Value grows with every member: 11% → 28% → 35% lower error at 2 / 4 / 8 labs (simulation).

WHERE THIS GOES

Today printed parts. Next, every precision machine

TODAY · 3D PRINTING

132 → 9 µm

Medical and bio labs: corrected designs that fit the first time, learned across labs (simulation).

NEXT · MICRO-SCALE

Sub-mm

Microfluidics and bioprinting: the sharing gain holds at 7–9% on sub-millimetre features (simulation).

VISION · SEMICONDUCTORS

Nanometres

Fabs and GPU packaging lines: tool data already sits in private silos, and learning across them nears a pooled model (imec, 2021).

One rule at every scale: machines learn their errors together; recipes, designs and measurements stay home. Fewer misprints, higher yield.

The network beats every single-lab baseline

Round 3, simulated fleets, head to head	Lower error	Fleets where it wins	p
Network vs single site alone	12.3% (1.6 µm)	75 / 100	<0.001
Pooled raw data (upper bound) vs alone	12.2%	64 / 100	
Ablation: sharing off, same agents	2.4%	56 / 100	0.27
Ablation: agents vs random test pieces	+1.0%	31 / 60	0.90
4 / 8 data-poor sites vs alone	28.5% / 34.7%	35/40 · 20/20	<0.001
Negative control: nothing shared	−13.0% (adaptive spread −0.4%)	19 / 60	0.006

Hidden-truth simulator, registered config, error against true size on held-out pieces, sign test over worlds. 90% intervals cover 90–91%. GPU posterior up to 84× NumPy on an H100. Reproduce: docs/validation-and-benchmarks.md.



Print anywhere, trust the part

Machines learn their errors together. Their data stays home. From microns today to nanometres next.

github.com/matte-realize/prebuilt